

IntelliJ IDEA - Installation & Setup

A complete guide to prepare the environment, install, configure, validate and perform the first functional use of the tool.

Manual objective

This manual guides you through the complete installation and setup process, from preparing the environment to final validation. Follow the steps in order and use the checks throughout the guide to confirm that each configuration was completed correctly.

Official references

<https://www.jetbrains.com/idea/download/>

<https://www.jetbrains.com/help/idea/getting-started.html>

Purpose

IntelliJ IDEA provides editing, refactoring, debugging, Maven/Gradle integration and Java test execution.

Official site and documentation

Use the official IntelliJ IDEA source as the primary reference: <https://www.jetbrains.com/idea/download/>. Official documentation should be the first source for installation, supported versions, syntax changes and new features.

QA Automation

It is useful for Selenium, REST Assured, JUnit, TestNG and Java frameworks.

Getting started

Install a JDK, open the Maven/Gradle project, let dependencies resolve and configure test execution.

Installation and configuration - overview

Always use the official website and documentation. Check prerequisites and compatible versions, install for your operating system, configure environment variables or PATH only when required, validate the installation with the recommended command or screen, and run a first project/test before integrating it into the QA workflow.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

How to start safely

Install IntelliJ IDEA from the official JetBrains source, confirm the required JDK is available and create or open a small project first. Validate build and test execution before adding plugins or complex project configuration.

First QA-oriented use

Pick one small, verifiable task in IntelliJ IDEA, configure only what is necessary, run a simple example and confirm the outcome. Repeat with different data or conditions before adding abstractions.

Using it in a real project

Define where IntelliJ IDEA fits, who owns configuration, how credentials and data are handled and how results are shared. Integrate it into the team workflow instead of creating an isolated activity.

Adoption good practices

Standardize versions and configuration, document important decisions, keep secrets out of code and preserve reproducible examples. Reassess whether IntelliJ IDEA still delivers value as the product evolves.

Common issues and troubleshooting

When IntelliJ IDEA fails, verify versions, dependencies, permissions, connectivity, data and environment before assuming a product defect. Preserve the original error and reduce the issue to the smallest reproducible case.